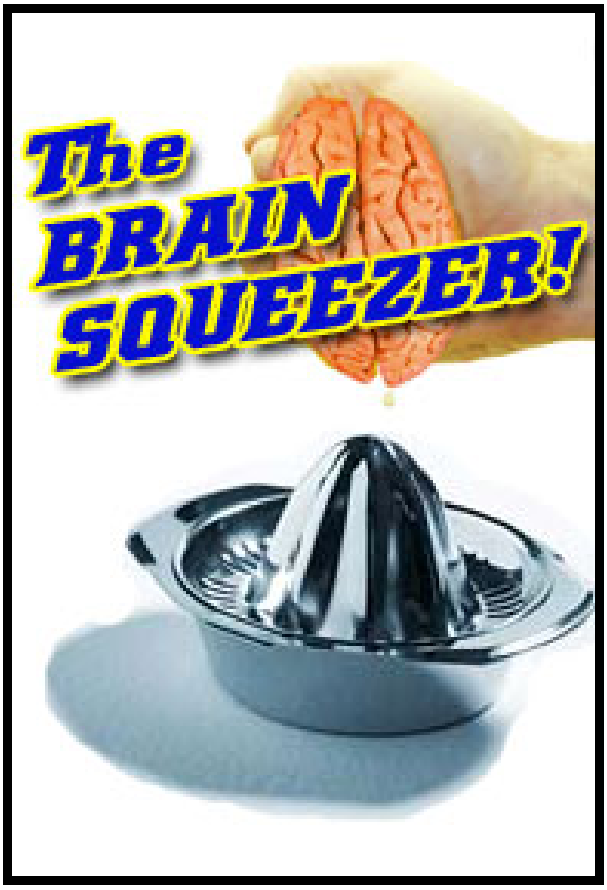
BRAIN SQUEEZERS Vol. 1

50 Ways To Get Your Juiciest Ideas and Genius IQ Power Flowing!



By Wily Walnut

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Introduction

Hello there,

If you are reading this it should mean that you are on my Brain Squeezers tips list and have been on it for quite a while.

For that… Mucho Thanks!

It's great to have YOU 'on board'!

I thought, by way of my saying thankyou, you might appreciate having the first 50 Brain Squeezers compiled together into an ebook format so that you can more easily refer to them.

Here it is… ***ta-dah!***

Wishing you the best of the best,
Wily

PS. If you have any friends who you think would value and benefit from these tips, please direct them to sign-up for them at my website. Thanks!

Brain Squeezer 001: Flick Gazing

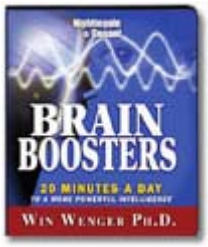
Time to read: 22 seconds

Purpose: Stimulates your brain, awakens your vision and perception.

Instructions: Spend 3-5 minutes, moving your eyes from one thing to another all around you. Let your eyes flick up, down, to the right, to the left, and on the diagonals, alighting briefly on a different feature or thing each time. Set the pace at 60 'flicks' per minute.

Notes: move your eyes, not your head.

Reference: 'Brain Boosters' by Win Wenger; published by Nightingale Conant.



Brain Squeezer 002: Expertless Thinking

Time to read: 55 seconds

Purpose: Leverage other brains' computing power. Get different perspectives and fresh ideas.

Instructions:

1. Get outside of your field. Get away from the 'experts'. Tap your social circle. Discuss challenges and problems with others. Seems like common sense, and it is. But we frequently forget. Ask your family. Ask a kid. Ask the milkman.

2. Seek out alert 'ideas people' in your social network. Get fired up by their love for ideas. Utilise their genius.

3. Adopt the belief that everyone has at least one idea that might be useful to YOU. Encourage them to reveal their creativity. Ask 'what would you do in my situation' type questions.

4. Keep your ears open. Listen to strangers. You never know when what you hear is going to help you out or trigger a blockbuster idea.

Reference: Chapter 21: Clevor Trevor -- '*Thinkertoys*' by Michael Michalko

Brain Squeezer 003: Insult Habit

Time to read: 58 seconds

Purpose: To break up mental status quo and let fresh creative energy flow.

Famed composer Igor Stravinsky believed that truly creative people always strive to 'insult habit'. The polymathic writer Arthur Koestler agreed, adding that creativity requires *'a new innocence of perception, liberated from the cataracts of accepted beliefs.'*

Instructions: Cataracts build up slowly over time gradually obscuring vision. Turn your awareness on your life. Examine your beliefs, your habitual ways of doing things, the little traditions and accepted practices that you do automatically. List all the things you do habitually and then deliberately program changes into your daily life. Throw a metaphorical stick of dynamite into your walled-in world. Break down the walls of routine. Do things differently. Look, listen, feel, taste, smell the world in new ways.

Clear your cataracts -- insult those habits!

Ideas:

- Read something you wouldn't normally read.
- Eat something you've never tried before.
- Experiment with your sleeping or working hours.
- Go somewhere you've never been.
- Be different!

Brain Squeezer 004: Forced Story

Time to read: 54 seconds

Purpose: Make your mental muscle work and tap awesome powers of imagination.

Kids wander around in a theta state and are great at spinning tall tales: fabulous adventures, romantic fantasies, heroic action stories, incredible excuses, inventive lies. It comes easy to them. Adult brains on the other hand are beta-fried!

Force your mind to produce stories at will and you will uncorkyour imagination and be able to use it for fun and profit.

Instructions: Set your stopwatch for five minutes. Write, type, dictate or tell a story as fast and as brilliantly as you can. Eliminate *'ums'* and *'ers'*. Focus on making it cohesive, entertaining and enthralling. It can be a children's story (parents will have some experience at this), an adult yarn, a Walter Mitty fantasy, or an outright lie of the most inventive kind.

Push your mind to work for you. Make it spill the juicy goods!

Brain Squeezer 005: Back From The Future

Time to read: 23 seconds

Purpose: Change the mental frame and liberate your perspective.

Instructions: Examine your problem or challenge. Get to know it inside out. Now imagine yourself ten years in the future. The problem is old news now. Look back on it fondly. You are way beyond that now. Notice everything about how you solved it. For best results, do this in a relaxed, meditative or hypnotic state.

Related articles:

Remote viewing to steal creative ideas from the future:

http://www.wilywalnut.com/Remote-Viewing-Future.html

Brain Squeezer 006: Verbalise Aloud

Time to read: 60 seconds

Purpose: Forces new neural connections and networks. Enhances observation. Deepens creative appreciation.

The German writer Goethe used to spark insights by verbalizing aloud. He would talk out loud to an imaginary friend, describing plots, characters and locations for his books. He believed this led to deeper understanding and highly imaginative, but realistic, writing.

American artist, James Whistler, also practiced verbalizing aloud. On city walks with friends, he would describe in detail what they were witnessing. To sharpen his powers of observation, he would try to memorize a scene, turn away from it and then describe it in as much detail as possible.

Win Wenger invented the Image Streaming process, in which you verbalize aloud while describing the stream of consciousness in your mind's eye. It's one of the top 5 creativity stimulators in the world and is said to boost your IQ.

Instructions:

Push yourself with all these exercises. Make your mind work.

1. Awareness Builder
Describe aloud what you are doing and sensing. 'I am typing on the keyboard. I am listening to my son play clarinet in the next room. I am moving my right foot.' etc.

2. Goals Aloud
Visualize the achievement of your number one goal in as much detail as possible. Describe aloud as you are visualizing. Describe what you see, in detail. Describe what you are feeling -- the sense of accomplishment, pride, fulfillment and gratitude. Describe what you are saying to yourself, what others are telling you. Do this for at least 5 minutes.

3. Splash in the Image Stream
Try Win Wenger's Image Streaming process (see *The Einstein Factor*). Relax somewhere you won't be disturbed. Close your eyes, breathe gently, and describe what's going through your mind's eye, in as much sensory detail as possible. Record this and listen to it later for greater brain benefits.

Additional References:

http://www.creativethinkingwith.com/Image-Streaming.html

http://www.wily-walnut.com/2007/07/verbalizing-out-loud-stimulates.html

Brain Squeezer 007: Know Satisfaction

Time to read: 67 seconds

Purpose: Reduce negativity, increase optimism, feel better about your life.

Notes: Three experiments were conducted at the University of California to determine the costs and benefits of writing, talking, and thinking about life's triumphs and defeats.

> **The first experiment** showed that merely thinking about negative experiences reduced overall life satisfaction, whereas writing about or talking about negative experiences led to increases in life satisfaction, mental health and social functioning.
>
> **The second experiment** showed that privately thinking about positive life experiences increased life satisfaction, but talking or writing about them didn't.
>
> **The third experiment** revealed that analysing positive events reduces feelings of satisfaction whereas simply replaying memories of positive experiences enhances well-being and increases life satisfaction.

Instructions: When you go through negative experiences, be they minor irritations or major life-shocks, write them down in detail. Explore and analyse your experience, thoughts and feelings

about those negative events. You can also discuss it with someone else... and hey, most of us do that anyway! But I think writing about it keeps your sh*t private.

Either way, writing about your negative experiences gradually detaches you from them and gives you a better perspective on them.

With regard to your positive experiences, it's best not to analyse them -- just reflect upon them privately in your mind and re-enjoy them.

References:

Lyubomirsky, S., Sousa, L., & Dickerhoof, R. (2006). *The costs and benefits of writing, talking, and thinking about life's triumphs and defeats.* Journal of Personality and Social Psychology, 90, 692-708.

URL: http://www.faculty.ucr.edu/~sonja/papers/LSD2006.pdf

Brain Squeezer 008: Alpha Better

Time to read: 75 seconds

Purpose: An easy and fast way to get your brain into a more creative state.

Use Silva Mind Method's simple 100-to-1 countdown method to allow your brain to produce predominantly alpha brain waves.

The 'alpha state' is associated with creative breakthroughs, and is much more user-friendly than theta state -- which is dreamy and harder to control.

You can use the Alpha mind state to think up solutions to your problems and challenges, re-program your subconscious to eliminate negative habits and improve your performance, or heal your body with visualization and affirmations.

Instructions:

Choose a place you can meditate and not be disturbed. Once you get the hang of this, you can do it anywhere -- waiting at the dentist; on the train; on a park bench!

Sit down. Put your cares aside. Close your eyes. Relax your body.

In your mind, start to slowly count backwards from 100.

Concentrate on the numbers as you count backwards *100 -- 99 -- 98 -- 97 etc*

You can imagine each number on a screen before you. But that's not essential. Simply count slowly backwards and relax more and more.

When you reach 1 (*I like to go down to ZERO*), you should feel very relaxed and calm. You are now in the Alpha state. Now is a good time to visualize your goals or think up creative solutions.

Practice for about 10 days, then reduce the count to 50-to-1 for another 10 days. After that you can keep halving it, as you should be finding it easier and easier to get into the Alpha state.

Eventually, you'll be able to close your eyes and go **3-2-1** ... and be in Alpha.

References:

'*The Silva Mind Control Method*' by Jose Silva

'*The Silva Method*' by Robert Stone, Audio Published by Nightingale-Conant

Brain Squeezer 009: Kleevision

Time to read: 1 minute 25 seconds

Purpose: To change your perspective and generate creative insights and breakthroughs.

The way you view the world influences the way you see it. If you change your frame of reference, the world appears different. Great artists know this and try to change the way they look at the world.

Famed Swiss painter, Paul Klee, came up with some simple ways to challenge his habitual perceptions by distorting sensory input.

Instructions:

1. Lense me your eyes

Use your camera, take pictures of people, places and things. Try different angles, lighting, and focal lengths. Things look different with a frame around them. Experiment with binoculars, magnifying glasses, camera zoom lenses and describe aloud the different things you notice. Draw or write down your thoughts and observations.

2. Reflections

Create your own 'lenses' to re-view the world around you. Use glass bottles, glass bricks, colored glass, plastic bottles, aluminum foil, and notice reflections on puddles, car windows, metal, shop windows etc. Distorted images can free up your

perception.

3. Sensory Twister

Distort your hearing by listening through a paper cup, a shell, a bucket (don't get your head stuck!), a towel and so on. Notice how sounds get distorted by walls and cloth, and by other noises.

Change your sense of touch by feeling things with your toes, your nose, or through your clothes *(sorry, I must be channelling Dr Seuss!)*.

Again take time to describe aloud, note down and or draw what you are noticing and experiencing.

The feedback loop is always so important in all brain boosting work!

References:

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Paul_Klee

Brain Squeezer 010: The Bullish Brain

Time to read: 54 seconds

Purpose: Overcome inertia, self-doubt and procrastination with forced confidence.

Observation: Some tasks turn you into a wet rag. You flop around unable to get going. You wait for Divine Inspiration to strike. But time ticks by and you remain uninspired.

Whenever you get in a creative funk, the fastest way out of it is to unleash the bull!

By that I mean, get aggressive, get charged up, and shout *'Geronimo!'* as you take a creative leap into the unknown.

Instructions:

Shake off the funk. Leap up from your chair and shake your fists like Lou Ferrigno playing *'The Incredible Hulk'* and roar!

Shout, stomp about and generally unleash all your pent-up, frustrated energy in one massive ***I CAN DO IT*** statement of intent.

And then get to it, with an angry fury!

Reflection: Your mind will mess you about with

self-doubts. Sometimes you just have to grab life by the scruff of the neck, shove your doubts in the bin, and get down to business. *Yeah! Yee-haw!*

Brain Squeezer 011: Camera Vision

Time to read: 1 minute 22 seconds

Purpose: Develop a poet's keeness of eye and vivid recall of imagery.

Observations: The famous poet, Percy Bysshe Shelley (husband of 'Frankenstein' author Mary Shelley) used a technique that sharpened his powers of observation and gave him an amazing ability to draw upon imagery in his writing.

In this, he has been likened to a human 'camera obscura'.

A camera obscura, such as a pin-hole camera, is a device for capturing an image and projecting it on a screen.

Shelley's camera obscura technique enabled him to replicate in his mind's eye a scene which he had recently experienced so vividly that his imagination would then produce poetic expressions about it.

Instructions:

1. Choose a scene or object that interests you.
2. Look at it, keeping your awareness in the here and now.
3. Notice all the subtleties of color, texture, shading, size, patterning (scent and taste if you close enough to get any impressions).
4. Close your eyes and try and replicate that scene or object in your mind's eye. You can

imagine it projected on the big screen of your mind.

5. When you've got it as clear as you can, open your eyes and check it against the real thing. Notice all the things you missed out. Make a mental note of the extra details.
6. Repeat exercise until you have got the internal mental image almost identical with the real thing.

Related articles:

'Secret techniques used by CIA, Secret Service & M15 to boost secret agents' brainpower."
Point 1. Observation.
http://www.wilywalnut.com/secretagent.html

'Sherlock Holmes' thinking secrets...'
Number 1. Observation...soaking up the facts.
http://www.wilywalnut.com/sherlock.html

References:

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Percy_Bysshe_Shelley

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Camera_obscura

'The Poetical Works of Percy Bysshe Shelley'.
Edited with a Memoir By H. Buxton Foreman.

Brain Squeezer 012: Inner Guide

Time to read: 2 minutes 2 seconds

Purpose: Create a personalized relationship with your unconscious mind. And free-up your unconscious resourcefulness through redirection.

Observation: The famous psychiatrist and founder of analytical psychology, Carl Jung, revealed in his autobiography that he often sought advice from his inner guide, Philemon.

> *"Philemon represented a force which was not myself... I held conversations with him, and he said things which I had not previously thought. For I observed that it was he who spoke, not I... Psychologically, Philemon represented superior insight."*

Personalizing the insights and intuitive messages from the unconscious mind makes them more accessible to your conscious mind.

This little bit of fiction bypasses the inner editor and delivers the messages in a more *brain-friendly* and acceptable manner.

Jung isn't the only one to have created an inner guide. Socrates spoke of his inner guide. Napoleon Hill famously consulted a mastermind inner board of advisers as revealed in *'Think and Grow Rich'*.

Recent studies suggest that far from being backward, children who claim imaginary friends grow up with better coping skills than those who don't.

Characteristics of Inner Guides:

- Human form
- Might be someone you know personally or by reputation. Or a complete 'stranger'.
- Represents some aspect of your self which you may not understand at the moment.
- May talk, ask questions, or communicate through symbols.
- May just provide reassuring presence.
- You might have several inner guides who can appear separately or together.

Instructions for establishing contact:

1. Relax, meditate, get calm.
2. Ask inwardly for your inner guide to appear.
3. Visualize yourself in a beautiful setting -- perhaps an Eden-like garden.
4. Gaze into a pool of water, imagine your reflection.
5. Feel your guide appear beside you.
6. Turn and say Hi!
7. Improvise however you want to get a clearer picture, understanding and feel for your guide. Get to know them in a way that feels right for you.
8. Ask for their name. Trust whatever comes up.

9. Ask if they have a message for you at this time.
10. Receive the message in whatever form it comes.
11. Thank them and say, see you soon!
12. Return to waking consciousness and note down your impressions and the message, and what it could mean.
13. Make it a practice to re-visit and converse with your guide. The more you do it the more real it will become.

Perspective: this little mental ruse unlocks your deeper resources.

Don't worry, you won't turn into a crazy schizo person unless you already are one. Have fun with it -- play with your mind.

Related article:

'Personalizing your subconscious mind power' http://www.wily-walnut.com/2007/04/personalizing-your-subconscious-mind.html

References:

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Carl_Jung

'Memories, Dreams, Reflections' by Carl Jung

'Think and Grow Rich' by Napoleon Hill

Brain Squeezer 013: Graphic Ideation

Time to read: 58 seconds

Purpose: Access right brain creativity.

Observation: Leonardo da Vinci used a scribbling technique to stimulate his creative mind. He would close his eyes and scribble all over a piece of paper. Then he would open his eyes and look for recognisable patterns, faces, objects or scenes in the mass of scribble.

Thomas Edison filled notebooks with sketches and doodles prior to establishing an idea in his mind. Many of them meant nothing to anyone else.

Instructions:

1. Take your problems and creative challenges and come up with pictures that represent the challenge. Imagine floating over your challenge and draw it from an aerial perspective.

2. Use the Alpha 100-to-1 countdown (see Brain Squeezer 008) to relax into a meditative state of mind. Taking the challenge as a starting point, observe the images and symbols that come to mind. As always, recording these aloud will help you greatly.

3. Draw the symbols and come up with a word that relates to each. First thing that pops into your mind. Then rewrite the words into a paragraph.

Compare drawings and paragraph looking for insights.

4. Draw your dreams. Play with symbols. Symbols represent things. *What things?*

5. Try Leonardo's scribble trick at break times. It teaches your mind to look for patterns and connections where there are none. This is great training for opportunity spotting and idea *mongering!*

Related articles:

Thomas Edison Invention Secret 6: Scribbling towards success!
http://www.wilywalnut.com/Thomas-Edison-Secret-6-Scribbling-towards-success.html

The Geniuses' Genius: Leonardo da Vinci
http://www.wilywalnut.com/leonardo.html

Reference:

Chapter 29, *'Thinkertoys'* by Michael Michalko

Brain Squeezer 014: Tennyson's Nuclear Shorthand

Time to read: 80 seconds

Purpose: Stimulate your creativity; come up with new ideas through associative thinking and mental flexibility.

Observation: The Victorian poet, Lord Alfred Tennyson, invented a technique called Nuclear Shorthand which he used to chase down and develop fleeting thoughts and ideas that seemed to ghost across the edges of his consciousness.

He would focus in on the scrap of information he had, be it a word or a short phrase, and he would use that as the central focus of his verbal mindmapping technique.

In this way, he was able to tap the brain's natural ability to create associations amongst all our thoughts and experiences.

This enabled him to flesh out the idea into full blown themes and concepts for his writings.

Instructions:

1. Use Nuclear Shorthand to explore an idea, word or phrase that just pops into your mind.

2. On a blank sheet of paper, write the 'nucleus' (the word, phrase or basic idea) in the center of the page and draw an oval around it.

3. Freely associate on the nucleus, allowing whatever ideas and impressions the nucleus stimulates to come into your mind. Remember, don't judge. Write down whatever comes to mind on a branch emerging from the nucleus. Circle that new idea.

4. Continue on like this, freely associating from one idea to the next. If you get stuck, return to the nucleus and see what else it makes you think of. Start a new branch.

5. As with all creative thinking exercises, adopt this Wily principle: *Play with it!* Don't obsess about a right or wrong way to do it. You will quickly get the hang of it and see the value in it.

6. Make your Nuclear Shorthand map and then notebook what insights and new ideas you have gained.

Reference:

Page 33, *'Secrets of Great Minds'* by John H McMurphy

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Alfred_Tennyson,_1st_Baron_Tennyson

Brain Squeezer 015: Attention Building

Time to read: 1 minutes 26 seconds

Purpose: Er...to build your attention ...and enable you to reach a state of focus quickly!

Instructions: Use sensory data to bring you right into the moment and 'out of your head'. We tend to drift around on *automatic*, hypnotized by our own stream of thoughts.

When you feel what you are feeling, see what you are seeing, hear what you are hearing, taste what you are tasting, and smell what you are smelling -- you lock into your body, into reality and the present moment.

You become aware. Your attention is in the here and now.

1. Listen. Is your computer humming? Listen to that sound. Be with it. Close your eyes and just listen to the sounds around you in the room you are in, and in the environment beyond. White noise such as the computer hum, a refrigerator buzz, or drone of traffic in the distance, can pull you right back into the present if you put your attention on it.

2. Feel. Feel your butt pressing against the chair. Feel the cloth of your shirt against your left arm. Feel the tingling sensation in your lips. Feel the sensation in your toes -- put your consciousness inside, so you are directly feeling your toes, not

imagining what the sensation of your toes is. There is a big difference. This internal perception is called aperception: you perceive afresh via your inner senses.

3. Notice how as you listening and feeling, you are not thinking. Try it. Tune into your senses, and you feel like this big bubble or plume of thought that seems to project out in front of you, collapses back into the body, into *the real*.

When you notice you are lost in thoughts, bring your attention back to the senses. Collapse thought by being fully present with your senses and bringing all your mental awareness to the present.

Use this ability whenever you need to focus on something important (like a lecture or a presentation from your boss).

Reference:

'Come To Your Senses' by Stanley H Block, M.D.

Brain Squeezer 016: Feed Your Mind

Time to read: 1 minute 54 seconds

Purpose: Fuel your creativity with new quality knowledge -- it's food for your mind!

Creative thinkers are infomaniacs! They constantly look to feed their minds with new knowledge and ideas. If you are not polishing off at least one non-fiction book a week, you are falling behind!

Here are some tips to add fuel to your creative fire...

Instructions:

1. The Reader's Mind Pump

a) Choose your reading material carefully. Sample a broad range of material but be selective. Ask: *'Is this going to benefit my creative mind?'*

b) Use the margins to note your thoughts, observations and ideas. I confess I find it painful to deface a book with my own notes -- but creatives from Mark Twain to Elvis Presley made copious margin notes as they read.

c) Outline the book before you start to read. Or read a chapter or two and then try and figure out what else it will say. Try it with a novel. George Bernard Shaw liked to play this imagination game.

2. Hit the magazine stand

Pick up a magazine that you've never read before in a niche you know nothing about. I think I read somewhere that Bill Gates does this. I know a lot of successful entrepreneurs do.

Hey, you never know what *'Carp Weekly'* might teach you about improving customer services at your telecom company or designing a widget to find lost earrings!

3. JFK's Nonfiction Challenge
Read nonfiction and try and find solutions to any problems presented in the book before the author reveals the solution. JFK loved this one apparently!

4. Read How-to books on varied subjects
Give you mind a workout by twisting authors' ideas into new ideas. Expose your mind to subjects that you don't have a natural interest in.

5. Read biographies
A lifetime of experience, thoughts and ideas packed into a couple of hundred pages. *What treasure!*

6. Visit TED.com
This is one of my favourite websites right now. You can watch 5-20 minute video presentations given by the top people in fields as diverse as technology, design, the arts, entertainment, business, culture, global issues.

7. Think about what you learn
See how one piece of knowledge relates to another. Make the connections, draw associations

between ideas. Look for trends and parallels. Use knowledge to spark new solution to old problems.

Brain Squeezer 017: Fluent Thinking

Time to read: 36 seconds

Purpose: Make your thinking more fluent and flexible.

Classic creative thinking courses will have you coming up with as many different uses for a paperclip as possible.

The idea behind this is sound. By challenging your mind to come up with the longest list of alternatives, you make your mind work hard and teach it to be more creative.

Instructions:

1. Take anything...an apple, a pen, a space rocket... and list alternative uses for it. Start with 10. Go for 20. *Squeeze out more!*

2. Grab 8 words from your newspaper...and try and come up with as many different sentences as you can.

3. Use the letters in number plates or people's names or company names as acronyms and come up with phrases that the acronym might stand for.

Examples:
Sally... **S**mart **A**nd **L**ikeable **L**awyer **Y**uppie
IBM... **I B**lame **M**icrosoft
TESCO... **T**his **E**ver-expanding **S**hop's **C**overt **O**perations

…. play with it and have fun.

Make sure you write down your lists of ideas -- this engages your mind in the activity more... and helps trigger new ideas.

Brain Squeezer 018: Collage Graduate

Time to read: 2 minutes 16 seconds

Purpose: Stimulate your imagination.

Observation: Surrealist artists discovered that creating collages stimulates the imagination. By pasting pictures or bits of pictures together on a collage, the individual parts lose their identity and become part of something new.

When two very different pictures are pasted together the imagination formulates them into a very different idea. In other words, the imagination will see a different use for the picture or give it a very different symbology.

Famous artists that used collages to generate amazing surrealist art?

Here's a sample: Max Ernst, Joan Miro, Robert Rauschenberg, and Jean Tingueley.

Max Ernst was always on the lookout for ideas that could liberate his mind from what he referred to as "ready-made reality". Creating collages freed him from the confines of the logical-rational mindstate and enabled him to think creatively.

Instructions:

1. Get a scrapbook or large sheets of art paper or card.

2. You'll need scissors and paper glue (pritstick is ideal).
3. Collect a bunch of different magazines, newspapers, catalogues, travel brochures, unwanted books etc.
4. Cut out pictures that interest you.

Max Ernst method:
Quickly paste pictures onto the page without any forethought or planning the end result. Let the collage form itself. Continue until you've used up all the pictures or until you 'feel' that it is complete. Record your thoughts in your notebook or journal.

Joan Miro method:
Gather your images before you. Move them around and look for unusual connections and meanings. Try to see new ways the images can go together. See in each image more than what we normally see. So an apple could be a ball, a planet, a bomb, a breast, a building, a wheel, whatever...

Notice how something interpreted in a new way might relate to another thing used in a new way. So if an apple is a wheel, a building could be the car body. Trust your impressions and enjoy the process of making unusual connections. When you have assembled your ideas, paste them onto the collage.

Rauschenberg and Tingueley Method
This one is fun because you get to make collages with objects.

You can use anything. Try it with the food on your plate. Or the change in your pocket. Or the contents of your drawer.

You can take random stuff and glue it together. Or weld metal together if you have the skills. I like to just grab what's at hand and assemble it in a pleasing way.

British sculptor Andy Goldsworthy goes out into the countryside and makes sculptures out of sticks or stones and then photographs them.

You can assemble leaves into patterns on the floor. You can make trash into a mandala or make a picture out of fast food packaging.

Play with the idea of making collages out of stuff.

Wily's Photoshop Fun method:
If you have a photo editing package like Photoshop, you can make collages on your computer. Just go to Google images and do some random searches, copy and paste the images you like into Photoshop. Then re-arrange them to create your own new collage pictures.

References:

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Max_Ernst

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Joan_Miro

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Robert_Rauschenberg

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Jean_Tinguely

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Andy_Goldsworthy

Brain Squeezer 019: Channelled Genius

Time to read: 65 seconds

Purpose: Bypass the logical-rational mind, sidestep the inner editor, free up your creativity, tap your genius.

Observation: Many famous writers, poets, artists, musicians and inventors comment that their best ideas came to them without their conscious participation. They give credit to Divine Inspiration or some greater intelligence.

> *"The poem 'Milton' was written from immediate dictation... I dare not pretend to be any other than the secretary; the authors are in eternity."*
>
> ~ William Blake, 1803

Instructions: Get into a relaxed focused state. Then pretend that you are a psychic channel like Esther Hicks and let inspiration pour into you and guide you as you write, draw, paint or sing. Just imagine some channel opening between you and the infinite creative source.

New age author Stuart Wilde revealed that he would regularly call upon the 'spirit' of famous dead authors to help him write his books. He sought to have them write through him.

Win Wenger gets people to imagine putting on the heads of famous geniuses in order to think like they do.

You can channel the wisdom of your 'higher self' (however you conceive that). Try it. Meditate and then give a talk into a tape recorder. Let yourself be surprised by your wisdom and natural authority.

Brain Squeezer 020: Celebrate Yourself

Time to read: 60 seconds

Purpose: Feel good about yourself and embrace a 'can-do' creative spirit.

Observation: People who doubt themselves and their abilities, rarely achieve anything. They give up faster. They attempt less. On the other hand, self-confident people recognize and value who they are and what they can do. This gives them the 'can-do' spirit that all creative people need.

Recommendation: Give yourself an ego boost. What you appreciate, grows in value. So appreciate yourself. Your brain will function better when you feel good.

> *"I celebrate myself and sing myself!"*
> ~ Walt Whitman
>
> *"Above all, thine own self-respect."*
> ~ Pythagoras

Instructions:

1. Personal development guru, Brian Tracy, suggests that you repeat to yourself everyday: *"I like myself. I love myself."*
Louise Hay, author of 'You Can Heal Your Life', offers the affirmation: *"I love and approve of myself."*
Try those affirmations and write down any impressions you get. If you think it's stupid or

egotistical, explore that and discover where you are resisting the idea that you are worth celebrating.

2. Take a few minutes to recall all your achievements and appreciate yourself. You learnt to walk? Way to go you! You are fluent in the English language? That's amazing -- well done! You can operate a computer? Wahoo -- give yourself a pat on the back! What else have you done? You've survived, you've made it to this moment. That is surely worth celebrating. Go on... Love yourself. You're yummy!

Fill in the blank:

I LOVE MYSELF BECAUSE...

Brain Squeezer 021: Wikipedia Wander

Time to read: 37 seconds

Purpose: Stimulate your mind with new knowledge.

Instructions:

1. Choose a topic you know very little about and take 5 minutes to go for a Wikipedia wander. Search for the topic at Wikipedia.org, read the first page, and as you are reading open up any interesting sounding links in a new browser tab or window.

2. If you are in a hurry, just skim the salient points to get a basic overview of the subject and return to it later to understand it better.

3. Look at the additional wikipedia entried you have opened in other tabs or windows. The wikipedia entries are structured very much like your brain works and you can discover all sorts of amazing things by following associated links.

Recent starting points for Wikipedia wanders I've been on in the last two weeks?

Heuristics. Scalar Fields. Henry VIII. Cybernetics. Cognitive Psychology. Content Analysis. Daniel Dennett. Computer architecture. Arthur Koestler. David Bohm. Obscurantism.

Brain Squeezer 022: Tenpowered Brain

Time to read: 70 seconds

Purpose: Useful brain code tools to make the most of your mind.

Observation: Dr Michael Hewitt-Gleason offer's a brilliant free course in thinking via his School of Thinking website. As part of that course he suggests two key bits of code to hardwire into your brain.

The first is 'CVStoBVS'
That stands for Current View of Situation to Better View of Situation. What it means is there is always room for improvement in your thinking and understanding so... keep looking for the better view of the situation!

The second bit of brain code he offers is Tenpower, or x10
Tenpower is a thinking tool. The way you use it is to ask yourself, in any given situation, how could I make this 10 times better? Or even just 10% better? Another great way to use Tenpower is with lists, where you force yourself to think of at least 10 different alternatives.

Instructions:

1. In your work, how could you do what you do 10% better this month?

2. List 10 things you are truly grateful for in your life.

3. Think of 10 ways you could benefit from using Tenpower in your life.

4. Think of 10 reasons you are definitely going to use the braincode CVStoBVS and Tenpower.

5. Visit Dr Michael Hewitt-Gleason's School of Thinking site and either sign up to his most current training program which you will receive via email, or download the ebook PDF of the course on this page of his site (I have no affiliation with his site):

http://www.schoolofthinking.org/about/cvstobvs-universal-brain-software/

Brain Squeezer 023: Concentration Cocoon

Time to read: 54 seconds

Purpose: Develop super-focused concentration.

Observation: Former SEAL Richard Machowicz reveals in his book, *'Unleash The Warrior Within'*, a special visualization he was taught during sniper training. He call's it the Sniper Bubble, and it builds laserlike concentration.

Instructions:

1. When you have a specific task to do, visualize a bubble around you that seals you off from the rest of the world.

2. The only things that matter are what happens inside that bubble. So, concentrate and bring all your attention and awareness to what you are doing. There should be a gradual shutting off of the outside world.

3. You are creating two worlds. The outside world of distractions. And the world of supreme focus within your bubble.

4. You will feel an intensity as your focus increases and all other distractions cease to exist. You are now focused-like a laser, in supreme control.

Remember, when you need to concentrate, first bring your **ATTENTION** right into the moment, be fully **AWARE** of what you are doing, **FOCUS** on

the task and exclude everything else, **CONTROL** your mind and make it as concentrated and intense as a laser.

References:

Chapter 5, *'Unleash The Warrior Within'*
by Richard J. Machowicz.

Published by Marlowe & Company.

Excellent book!

Brain Squeezer 024: World Text

Time to read: 74 seconds

Idea: See the world as alive and responsive to you. See it as communicating with you through signs and symbols.

Example: Some Native American tribespeople read events and happenings as though they are signs. Let's say they are hunting a deer in the woods. The deer gets wounded and gets away from them. They don't know which direction it has gone in. Suddenly a bird flies up. They see the bird's flight path as a 'sign' of the direction they should go in. As though the Universe were flashing them a pointer arrow. They follow the direction the bird flew in. They find the deer.

Context 1: William James, the American philosopher, pioneered the idea of pragmatism, which is where you embrace somthing as good not necessarily because you can prove it to be true but because acting as though it it is true helps you do other things.

Context 2: It is a creative act to attribute meaning and significance to objects and events in your environment. This action forces neural connections by making your associative mind see patterns and meanings in random events.

Context 3: Seeing the Universe as friendly and responsive to you, gives you a confident mindset that makes you more expressive, better at making

decisions, and enlarges your paradigm of where your mind begins and ends.

Note: This is rather like dream interpretation, but using the 'dream' of reality instead. You can ask questions and expectantly look for the answers and guidance in your world around you.

Playing mental games like these seems to engage what we could call the Universal Mind. You become 'plugged in' to something bigger and initially mysterious. Your life becomes full of synchronicity and meaning...

Engage.

References:

“The Celestine Prophecy” by James Redfield (provides a good introduction to idea of living by synchronicity).

Brain Squeezer 025: Brain Bullets

Time to read: 2 minutes 37 seconds seconds

Purpose: Learn to fire powerful new instructions into your brain to draw upon your amazing potential.

Observation: Brain plasticity or neuroplasticity is "the lifelong ability of the brain to reorganize neural pathways based on new experiences."

What it means is that you, your personality, your habits, are not set in stone. Your brain can adapt and change. That means YOU can change.

You don't have to stay stuck as the person you think you are. You don't have to argue for your limitations. You are here to evolve, change and activate more and more of your potential.

There are techniques and tools you can use to accelerate your ability to change. These will help you mutate from the old you to the new improved you!

Instructions:

1. Environmental sweep

Whether you agree with the concept and validity of Feng Shui or not, it's a fact that your environment will influence the way your brain works.

Simple tip:

Align your environment with your goals and fill it with triggers that will fire off your inner images of success and the achievement of your goals.

Want a relationship? Put pictures of happy couples in your rooms.

Looking to improve your golf game? Add that statuette of the golfer with the perfect swing to your office desk.

Want to be organised and productive? Then keep your files tidy. The subconscious mind is watching all the time. It can see when you are being consistent with what you claim you want.

Program your mind by arranging your environment so that it supportsyour dominant desires.

2. Repetition rules!

Habitual behaviours follow well-used neural pathways in your brain. eg. You get stressed and immediately that triggers a particular synapse to fire down a neural pathway that has you reaching for some junk food to comfort yourself with.

To break that habit, you need to force yourself to do something different, such as taking a few deep breaths to relax and center yourself again.

If you repeat that activity every day for 30 days, you will be creating a new neural pathway and 'erasing' the old one. Persist in this new habit for several months and it will become the automatic default reaction to stress.

3. Re-program the brain

You can re-program your brain with the deliberate application of new positive habits described above. You can also re-program the brain with thoughts and visualized images. The key with visualization is always to imagine what you want rather than what you don't want.

Habituate your mind outside of your visualization 'sessions' so that it always thinks about the desired outcome rather than the current situation that you want to change.

With re-programming the human biocomputer (your brain) the key is momentum and leverage. The more you can do it, the faster the result.

Leverage your time by making use of tools designed to help you achieve positive changes. You can turn to hypnosis, affirmations, and so on.

4. Fire new instructions into your brain

If you like the idea of multi-tasking like me then you will love the Brain Bullet software. Install it on your computer, choose the particular program you want to install as new program in your brain and fire it up.

While you are working on your computer, it flashes subliminal statements on the screen that will fire straight into your unconscious mind. I've got it on as I am writing this -- and it's set on a Health program that is firing statements into my mind that will change my unconscious beliefs and hang-

ups about health, helping me to release and heal. I've been using it for about two weeks so far.

Already I am exercising more consistently and the long term sciatica I've been suffering has faded... like I've just forgotten about it and it's no longer bothering me.

Resources: If you want to check out the Brain Bullet software, just visit this URL:

http://www.wilywalnut.com/brainbullet.html

My favorite re-programming statement?

"I AM A GENIUS AND I APPLY MY WISDOM."

Repeat daily.

(Thanks to health guru Paul Bragg for that one.)

Brain Squeezer 026: Backwards Progress

Time to read: 63 seconds

Purpose: Stimulate your brain; throw a spanner in the habit machine; grow new neural paths; access subconscious resources.

Note: Leonardo da Vinci scribbled his notes in mirror writing (backwards). He could write and draw equally well with either hand. He could write or draw with both hands at the same time (two different things).

Instructions:

1. Take a minute or two every day to write backwards ie. reverse your letters. This unfamilliar action forces your mind to pay great attention, to think hard, and to be confused. When you are in that state of confusion, as long as you persist in your practice, you are learning.

Feeling awkward and clumsy at a new skill is a horrible feeling that most of us avoid. We don't want to look stupid. Reframe that attitude and take a vicious pleasure in seeking out new learning situations where you don't know what you are doing. Take up a new sport. Go on scary rides.

2. You can just write anything that comes to mind backwards. I like to write poetry. Somehow writing backwards opens the door to my right brain creativity and subconscious imagery. Try it yourself. When you're done, hold your paper up to

a mirror so you can check your handwriting and see what you've written!

Advanced Alternatives:

3. Write forwards or backwards with your non-dominant hand.

4. Try writing your words upside down.

C'mon shake that mind up!

Brain Squeezer 027: Accuracy Before Speed

Time to read: 1 minute 16 seconds

Purpose: To give you the foundation strategy for excellence in any skill or thinking endeavour.

Observation: We live in an instant gratification world so use your common sense where you apply this strategy.
Sometimes it is better to do something badly fast than to be so obsessed with perfection that you don't get round to delivering anything at all. However some things require a greater degree of perfection than others. Like heart surgery. Best not to charge in there!

"Well done is quickly done."

~ Augustus Caesar

Instructions:

1. When learning a new skill... such as a martial art, snowboarding, building a website, typing, playing an instrument etc ... focus on the fundamentals and go over and over and over them. Start slow and accurate. Keep practicing and perfecting the basic movement. Do it in slow motion. The brain gets to fully experience every moment and motion of a movement.

Build the neural pathways. When they are built, the movement of that new skill will be automatic -- then you can get faster or work on the complicated actions!

2. When you are thinking about something, double-check for accuracy. Are you sure your over-confidence is not blinding you to mistakes and errors? Most of us are so lazy that we take mental shortcuts to the answer.

Perhaps that is a result of a test driven education system where it's first one to stick their hand in the air.

When you train yourself to check your thinking for accuracy, you also become more aware of whether the right answer is actually the right answer, and whether there is a better question.

Brain Squeezer 028: Infinite Intelligence

Time to read: 1 minute 56 seconds

Purpose: Create the conditions for super thinking.

Instructions:

Your mind requires permission to use it's extraordinary powers of creativity, insight, innovation and intuition.

The way to allow your mind to think at it's best is to give it a better framework or belief system to operate within.

Your current belief system includes the idea that your brain is somehow limited. You think at some level that there is a limit to how brilliantly you can think. But you are exploring how to change that and are open to new ideas...

1. Decide now that there is an Infinite Intelligence in the Universe.
It's just a concept. Not a religion. If your spiritual beliefs are concurrent with it, fine. If you are agnostic or atheist, treat it simply as a mental construct that you are creating to achieve a certain purpose.

2. Generate reasons to support this belief.
Include reasons why this belief will benefit you.

3. Visualize or imagine this Infinite Intelligence and its connection to you.

You can imagine an incredible source of light, the source of all life. You can imagine a hall of records, a kind of repository of all knowledge and all design, the palace of archetypes, or something akin to the Akashic Records (look it up!).

You might imagine a universal computer, the ultimate hard drive to which we are all 'internettedly' and wirelessly connected!

4. Further that visualization with the idea that you are now and always connected with a massive broadband pipe of light connecting your brain, your mind... YOU!... with this Infinite Intelligence that has all the answers.

5. Imagine having a question, holding that question in mind, and the question travelling at the speed of thought to this Universal Computer, the calculations are made, the alternatives listed and generated for you, the package of possible answers delivered back to you via the pipe.

Embrace being a genius. Embrace the idea of having access to Infinite Intelligence.

> *"We can show that each of the 10 billion neurons in the human brain has a possibility of connections of one with 28 noughts after it! If a single neuron has this quality of potential, we can hardly imagine what the whole brain can do. What it means is that the total number of possible combinations / permutations in the brain, if written out, would*

be 1 followed by 10.5 million kilometres of noughts! No human yet exists who can use all the potential of his brain. This is why we don't accept any pessimistic estimates of the limits of the human brain. It is unlimited!"

~ Professor Petr Anokhin
Moscow University

(As quoted in Tony Buzan's *Book of Genius*.)

Brain Squeezer 029: VR Thinking

Time to read: 1 minute 30 seconds

Purpose: Develop your powers of imagination. Uncap the creativity juice!

Instructions:

Turn off the TV. Get off YouTube. Put the Playstation in the cupboard. Cancel your subscription to Blockbuster. And turn on the ultimate entertainment system -- your mind!

'Imagination rules the world,' Napoleon claimed. And for a while he ruled a nice chunk of it so he should know.

Did you ever watch an episode of the tv series, *'Ali McBeal'*? She was one of the first TV characters I was aware of who had a very vivid imagination that the viewer got to see.

She would be talking to someone and then imagine some scenario with them. Or she'd be imagining cute little dancing babies following her around.

Now you see similar things in comedies like *'Scrubs'* where "JD" will tilt his head and go off into a little virtual reality fantasy.

The 'head tilt, gaze up and to the side' is now a TV cue for some kind of imaginary experience.

I want you to include some *Head Tilt Time* in your day.

Have yourself 'a moment'.

And go into your virtual reality playground.

Here are a few guidelines:

- This is YOUR world. You are the writer and director, the cameraman, the lighting technician, the set designer, the recording guy or gal.

- Because it's YOUR world, you can make it perfect. This is virtual reality, and you can have it just right for you.

- Enrich your imagery with NLP. Same with sounds and feelings. Make it brighter or darker, more or less colorful to suit. Speed it up or slow it down. Make it louder or quieter. Intensify the good feelings and lessen any bad feelings. Make it right for YOU.

- Ester Hicks, the author and channel of 'Abraham' says that you can create the experiences you want in virtual reality. As long as you enjoy them as though they were real, they can come true. And if they don't it won't really matter as you are experiencing it anyway in virtual reality and the brain registers vividly imagined events as strongly as real events. (Near enough anyways.) Hicks

reminds us to leave out everything we don't want from our VR world.

Virtual reality thinking gives you the emotional freedom to express and experience whatever you want. Have fun with it. It gives your imagination a wonderful workout.

Brain Squeezer 030: Smell Bell

Time to read: 1 minute 43 seconds

Purpose: Stimulate your brain and create powerful memory triggers.Use smells to generate unusual associations and new insights.

Observation: Smells are deeply linked in with memories. A whiff of a particular perfume can whoosh you back through the years to remember that special someone who wore that scent.

Smells seem to work powerfully on the reptilian complex or brainstem of your brain. When a scent is linked with a particular experience, that experience can be recalled immediately you smell that scent again.

Instructions:

1. Start collecting aromatherapy scents
They are easy to buy these days from health stores, supermarkets or chemists. Start off with lavender, sandalwood (my favourite), rose, rosemary, pine, eucalyptus and gradually build a collection of scents you can use to trigger your mind.

2. A little snifter
When you are learning something new, take out a particular scent and just take the odd sniff from the top of the bottle. Or put some of the scent in an oil burner.

3. Ring the smell bell
Each time you study or revise that subject, sniff that same scent. The learning will get tied up with the smell. You can then trigger better recall by sniffing that scent (or imagining it) prior to exams or presentations.

4. United Scents of America
In the book, *'Keep Your Brain Alive'* by Lawrence C. Katz, he suggests using smells to associate with specific areas of a neighbourhood, so that you form a kind of smell map to learn your way around.

5. The right notes
Another great suggestion is to combine different kind of musics with a specific scent. This is done not to create particular memories but just to see what associations come up and what insights it triggers. Katz suggests pairing pine with country and western music, lavender with the first movement of Beethoven's Sixth Symphony, or cloves with Muddy Waters singing the blues. *Smells good to me.*

Would you like a Mind Mapping software bundle, Top Motivation Software, a Memory Course, 2 Hypnosis Downloads and many more self growth bonuses for ZERO cost?

Help yourself at:
http://www.wilywalnut.com/Self-Growth-Gifts.html

Brain Squeezer 031: Gurdjieff STOP!

Time to read: 56 seconds

Purpose: Wake up. Break out the trance. Become more fully aware and alive!

Background: Metaphysician G.I. Gurdjieff asserted that people, in their typical state, were unconscious automatons, but that it was possible for a man or woman to wake up and experience life more fully. He taught the STOP exercise as part of his Fourth way approach to self-development.

Instructions:

1. Your Surpriser Pal

The best way to do the STOP exercise is to get a friend to call you at completely random times of the day and yell, 'STOP!'

You can do the STOP exercise yourself but as part of you will be anticipating it you won't get optimum results.

You will still notice a marked increase in your awareness and mental energy or mind power. Any way you can figure how to generate a randomized alarm signal will help ensure you have the surprise element that will catch you in your moments of automatic behaviour.

2. Become a living statue

When you get the STOP signal, stop right in mid-action, allow your eyes to focus intently on what's before you, and hold whatever thought is in your mind.

3. Timeless Torture!

Gurdjieff would insist that his students hold their position, even if it was awkward and painful, anywhere from a few seconds to ten minutes or more.

You can decide how much time you have to devote to this. But don't kid yourself just to get out of it.

Hold still. Watch, feel, experience!

4. Shock yourself awake

Force all your mental energy into the moment. Wake up and be really and truly aware of where you are, what you are doing, what you are thinking. Break up the obvious, the habitual, the automatic. Smash it with the hammer of 'furious' awareness. Stop sleeping through life!

Brain Squeezer 032: Opportunity Spotting

Time to read: 2 minutes (but well worth it!)

Purpose: Develop a mental frame for spotting ideas and opportunities.

I read about a great technique called Money Goggles that I recommend you use. It will sharpen your mind to the boundless opportunities around you. Here's what you do...

Instructions:

1. Look around you and select an object. Any object.

2. Analyse that object, the different bits that make it up, how it got to you.

3. Think about all the different people who contributed to that object being where it is.

Here is an example:

An apple: I bought it from the supermarket. It came in a plastic bag of 6 apples. The plastic bag has nutritional information on it, the text and labels on it are laid out in a unique way, there is a story on it about the apple grower. So just producing this plastic bag involved nutritionists, graphic designers, copywriters.

Somebody made the little yellow sticky tape that seals the bag.

Somebody made the machine that prints the date and code on the little bit of sticky tape.

Somebody made the yellow dye that colors the tape.

Somebody chose the right size of bag.

Somebody set up the plastic bag machinery to produce bags this size.

Somebody invented the machines and built them that produce the plastic bags.

Somebody negotiated with the plastic bag makers to get the best prices.

To get that apple to the supermarket required trucks and planes, drivers and pilots.

People to carry the boxes to and from warehouses.

People to make the cardboard boxes the apples were packed in.

People to make and design the protective moulds that separate the apples during transit, and the big crates that the boxes are loaded in.

There are warehouses that have to be built and maintained to hold the apples en route.

Then there are the apple experts. Buyers. Tasters. Apple scientists. Negotiaters.

And there's the apple farmer. And he needs to employ pickers.

He needs machinery for his orchards.

He needs special chemicals and fertilisers to maximise his yield.

He needs apple seeds! There are people who sell those things.

These are all opportunities for somebody somewhere.

4. Start to look around you and see not just the object but the whole story behind that object. When you do this you open up your vision. You see the possibilities. And you'll appreciate how lucky we are.

- What are you missing?
- What haven't you noticed before?
- What service could YOU provide?
- What widget could YOU make as part of this chain of supply?

Get your opportunity spotting glasses on!

Reference: The 'money goggles' technique is just one of the great techniques revealed in... *'How to make Money on Demand'* by Jason Oman and Mike Litman.
See: http://www.wilywalnut.com/Money-On-Demand.html

Brain Squeezer 033: Idea Stalking

Time to read: 62 seconds

Purpose: Insight into cultivating ideas.

Observation: Earlier I was walking in the countryside thinking about creativity. Ahead was a large stubble field beside a forest. There were two deer that had crept out from the forest to graze on the field. When they saw me they ran away, a few quick silent bounds and they were back in the dark woods. 'How do those deer relate to creativity?' I wondered.

Like the deer, ideas creep out of the dark woods of your unconscious mind into the edges of your field of consciousness. Usually when you least expect them.

Deer are nervous flighty creatures that take alarm if you make a loud noise or make sudden movements or get upwind of them. Ideas can be as fleeting.

If you ignore ideas for even a few moments and then turn back to them, they can have disappeared already.

If you let the ego rush to grab them and control them, you are like a big blustering monster and the ideas can flee before you've really grasped the full beauty of them.

Sneak up on your new ideas. Maintain a soft inner gaze that can observe them without focusing your 'sniper lens' on them.

When you grab for an idea too soon you will grab it by the throat and not realise that you've throttled it before it has fully developed. Be gentle with your ideas. Let them take their time in your field of consciousness.

Watch them. Let your appreciation and understanding of them grow. Let your ideas fully form.

Maintain a soft peripheral gaze on new ideas. Allow them to formulate before you grab for them. Like stalking a deer, if you grab for it, run towards it or make a big noise it will run away.

Brain Squeezer 034: World Ruler

Time to read: 60 seconds

Purpose: Re-awaken possibility thinking.

Observation: As most of us get older, reality checks start to shut down our possibility thinking. We stop even entertaining wild ideas.

Instruction:

1. Ask yourself (and your friends/family) this question:

"What would I do if I ruled the world?"

You rule. No commitees. No checks and balances. You are the leader, the emperor or empress of the whole world -- your word is law. Let your mind run wild with the possibilities.

Background: The other night I was sitting for dinner with my family. We were all fairly quiet, not saying much.

So, I came up with that question, as a conversation starter (how sad am I!). My little son didn't even need to stop to think about. He blurted out two ideas straight away.

"I would make Peace throughout the world. I would ban all guns (except game guns) and shoot anyone who used any other kind of gun."

<Okay, so his sense of irony needs some development!>

"I would also make these little pellets to fuel cars with, and each pellet would have enormous energy in it and be filled with the power of a million people's farts!"

Well, that's my son for you. What about you? Do you share his vision of a fart-powered world :-)) or do you have you own vision?

What would YOU do if YOU ruled the whole world?

Brain Squeezer 035: Brain Balance Walk

Time to read: 1 minute 19 seconds

Purpose: Balances the bilateral brain and provides positive neural stimulation - hey it's a mini brain workout!

Instructions:

1. Choose a space in your office, living room, garden, or local park, where you can walk with no obstacles in the way for five to ten minutes.

2. Walk in a figure of eight pattern.

3. That's it! That's all you need to do.

It's called Infinity Walking ...because the side-ways figure of eight is the ancient Egyptian symbol for Infinity or Infinite Life.

EEG biofeedback brain wave readings while infinity walking consistently show...

> *"...increased brain response across the hemispheres and across a broad range of brain wave frequencies (rhythmic timing of various specialized neurons). The shift in neural response was similar to that seen when a person's attention has been fully engaged and stimulated by a completely novel and intriguing experience."*

Translation: This is good for your brain!

Tips: Buddhist monks practice meditation while walking. It's really wonderful. Why not combine your figure of eight walking with meditation for an amazing way to relax, de-stress and expand your awareness? Walking slowly and mindfully, feeling each step, maintaining awareness of your breathing…

Advanced Brain Walking

Accelerated learning: Do this brain balancing walk while listening to foreign language tapes or other learning programs. Figure eight walking puts you into a hyper-learning state.

Creative thinking: Do the brain walk while thinking about a creative challenge. Discuss your problem out loud, describing the main points and possible solutions. Let the infinity walk dissolve obstacles and provide solutions. If you do it in your yard at night in semi-darkness, you can combine with eyes-open image streaming for amazing results.

Reference:

http://www.infinitywalk.org

Brain Squeezer 036: Zero Resistance

Time to read: Ages -- you'll probably want to put it off.

Purpose: Overcome inner resistance and get creative!

Notes: My current favourite read is Stephen Pressfield's *'The War Of Art'*. It describes the inner resistance we have to being creative, all the different manifestations it takes, and how to overcome it and get on with being creative.

When you go to get up in the morning, your desire to get up has to overcome the forces of inertia (the nice warm bed, gravity, tiredness).

When you want to lift a box off the floor and put it on the shelf, you have to exert muscular tension and energy to overcome the weight of the box and the pull of Earth's gravitational field.

When you want to write a book, you have to overcome distractions, diversions, lack of motivation, writer's block and a whole cacophany of different manifestations of resistance.

For everything you want to do there is a measure of resistance against which you must struggle.

All creative illumination casts a shadow called resistance that tries to stop you acting on your inspiration.

Instructions:

1. Get clear on what you want to achieve and why.

2. Before you begin acknowledge that there will be resistance. Resistance is the enemy of your success. Treat it that way.

3. Adopt a powerful persona. Enlarge your self-concept. Become a creative super hero, in your own mind at least. Give yourself the kind of identity that can overcome any obstacle.

4. There are two ways to overcome resistance. You will have to use both ways. The hard way is to fight it. This requires a horns-down charge right ahead approach. Be absolutely beligerent in your refusal to be distracted from what you HAVE to do.

This is the JUST DO IT approach. This is all about discipline. Paying homage to your craft; be it writing, composing, painting, inventing, selling widgets or whatever. Basically it means getting it done whether you feel like it or not.

> *"I write only when inspiration strikes. Fortunately it strikes every morning at 9 o'clock sharp!"*
>
> ~ Somerset Maugham

5. The soft way is to let go. You see, you ARE the resistance! It's YOU that is resisting change. You are the Creator. And just as the Creator creates positive and negative polarities in this world, so

you create positive and negative polarities in your own inner world.

To achieve flow, or equilibrium, you also need to let go of the battle, let go of positive and negative -- and rise above it all to where it just happens.

What just happens?

You. Creating...

6. To let go ask, "Could I let go of my resistance to (fill in the task)?" If the answer is yes, proceed to next question. If no, soften the question, and make it something like, "Could I let go of my resistance just for now and just for fun?".

Then ask, "Would I be willing to let go of my resistance...?"

If the answer is YES, then go ahead and ask, "When?" and you are aiming for the answer to be RIGHT NOW.

7. The YES/NO 'answers' are gut feelings. You just want to feel your yes or no. Play with this until it becomes intuitive and just trust that it is working for you. I appreciate this is kind of fuzzy thinking. However, you can create a kind of grading system to check the level of your feeling.

Score yourself out of ten by asking, from the start, "What is my level of resistance out of 10?" and trying to lower it by repeating the exercise until

you feel like you have let go of the energy blocks that you are working on.

References:

"The War of Art" By Steven Pressfield

Self-styled *'Zen Master of the Internet'* Matt Furey promotes an updated version of Maxwell Maltz's *'Psycho-Cybernetics'* under the banner of Zero Resistance Living. Through visualizing your goals and building a stronger, better self-image he says life becomes more effortless.
http://www.psycho-cybernetics.com

The famous Sedona Method focuses on letting go of resistance by asking specific questions to unlock your emotions.
http://www.sedona.com

Lifetools CEO Chris Payne promotes a seminar program called the Effort-Free Life program, which utilizes a mix of questions, goal-setting and 'miracle working' to attain the resistance-free life.
http://www.effortfree.com

To help you overcome your own inner resistance to creativity and productivity, refer to some of the resources mentioned above.

You might also like to try Dr Neil Fiore's Productivity Engineering hypnosis program. I am reviewing this currently. It doesn't have all the

bells and whistles I'm used to with Hypnosis CDs, but the content seems to be very effective and coming from a rigorous source.

You can read more about it at: http://www.wilywalnut.com/Productivity-Engineering.html

Brain Squeezer 037: Great Attitude

Time to read: 1 minute 50 seconds-ish

Purpose: Discover the fastest way to feel terrific, expand your consciousness, and become deeply fulfilled -- while making other people happy too.

Observations: Everyone loves the person who has a great attitude. They make better friends because they are warm, wise and fun to be around. They make better employees because they are enthusiastic and appreciative. They make super bosses because they are visionary leaders who care for their staff and customers as much or more than the bottom line.

If a great attitude does all this, what is a great attitude and what's the fastest way to get it?

The way I figure, if we are going to figure out these two words we better get them close together so we can really focus on them. Let's squish them together. What do we have?

A great attitude is…

great + attitude = GRATITUDE!

Practicing gratitude is the fastest and best way to achieve a great attitude.

Studies conducted by Robert A. Emmons at the University of California show that there are definite

benefits to showing gratitude and building gratefulness as a value in your life (see resources).

Instructions

Basic:

1. Start your day with a great question from Tony Robbins: *"Who do I love, and who loves me?"* That will put you in an appreciative mood.

You can also start thinking about things you can be grateful for such as, breakfast, nice clothes to wear, your car or the bus ride to work, a nice smile from a fellow traveller.

2. End your day by thinking of (or writing in your journal) at least 3 things you are grateful for from this day. Bring each to mind, feel good about it, and think or whisper your thanks. Say, 'I am so grateful for... whatever it is'.

Feel your feelings. Amplify your feelings. Enjoy feeling gratitude.

Advanced:

3. Visualize your goals as though you have already achieved them and express your gratitude to Life, the Universe, GOD or whatever for the manifestation of what you desire. This is heap good magic!

Enhance it further by image streaming and describing aloud your goal achievement and grateful feelings.

4. *Aaahhh, grasshopper,* ultimate gratitude enlightenment comes when you can feel gratitude for not just the 'good' things in your life, but also the so-called 'bad'!

Work your Creator magic by reframing all negative experiences and events as learning opportunities.

When you can feel grateful even for the sh*t hitting the fan, you are truly advanced!

Reference:

Robert A Emmons: Highlights from the research project on Gratitude and Thanksgiving:
http://psychology.ucdavis.edu/labs/emmons/

Thank and Grow Rich
http://www.thankgrowrich.com

Hey! .... Thank YOU!! :-)

Brain Squeezer 038: RAS-pect

Time to read: 2 wonderful minutes and 11 super seconds

Purpose: Engage your Recticular Activating System to become more creative and achieve your goals faster.

Observations: You see what you are looking for. Your RAS is like a mind radar that locates whatever you are currently focused on. It filters the 2 million bits of information that hit your senses every second down to 7 plus or minus 2 bits of information, thus stopping you going mad!

If you stand by a busy road and I tell you to shout out whenever you see a blue car, you will notice all of the blue cars.

If I then ask you how many black cars you saw, you won't know, because you weren't looking for black cars. But you'll start noticing them right away.

You can activate your RAS to serve you in achieving your top goals. Used right it will seem to exert a magic on the Universe, seeming to attract people, things and experiences that relate to your goal.

Instructions:

1. The more passionate about and strongly focused on your goal you are the better. Sorry but

you really need to kick your own butt until you figure out your dominant chief aim in life.

Come on, make it a nice juicy one that you will slobber over and obsess about!

2. Write out your goal, describing in detail what you will be experiencing when your goal is achieved. Caveat: 'goal' tends to imply losing weight, getting the house of your dreams and all that jazz that you get in goal setting books.

It can just as easily apply to becoming spiritually more enlightened and wise; furthering your toy train collecting hobby; or for us creatives, having more and better ideas.

3. Spend time every day focusing on and thinking about your dominant chief aim. If you have chosen correctly this will be easy. Teenage boys think about their dominant chief aim all day and all night long. We want that kind of obsession, ideally, but with cleaner sheets!

4. You are driving the message into your subsconscious mind that this is really important to you. You can help this process by visualizing, repeating affirmations relating to your goal, buying books, CDs, DVDs and courses relating to your goal, talking about it, thinking about it, putting up pictures relating to it.

You know all this personal development stuff -- so do it, and watch what happens as your RAS engages and goes to work helping you achieve

your wants and desires relating to this.

5. With regard to creativity and getting more and better ideas, the secret to engaging your RAS here is simply the discipline of recording what ideas and insights you do have.

This gives massive feedback to your creative mind that ideas are important and valuable to you. It will generate more for you. Write them down. *Think it - Ink it!*

Reference:

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Reticular_activating_system

Chapter 4, *'Turning Passions Into Profits'* by Christopher Howard

'Think and Grow Rich' by Napoleon Hill

Brain Squeezer 039: Winners Ways

Time to read: 60 seconds

Purpose: Boost your self-esteem, re-evaluate your self-image, see yourself as a winner, build confidence and achieve more.

Observations: We tend to compare ourselves unfavourably to famous people. Enough of that!

Instructions:

1. You're a winner

You are going to start noticing something you've overlooked most of your life. *What's that?* The fact that you WIN all day long!

What!?? Am I crazy?

No way, listen up...

2. Win after win

What was the first thing you did this morning? You woke up right. And then at some point you thought, 'I'm gonna get up now.'

What happened? Did your body seize up and you couldn't move a muscle? Did the sheets leap up and try to throttle you? Did you give up?

No, at some point you got up out of bed. You were successful at getting out of bed.

You probably then decided to go to the bathroom

for a pee. Am I right? I'm guessing that you got there and you did that pee. *Wahoo* -- that's another win for you!

You decided to do something and then you did it!

3. Win List
For the next 24 hours, list your 'wins'. List every little thing that you decided you wanted to do and you did it.

4. To Do List
Thereafter, before you go to sleep at night, just jot down a list of things you are going to do tomorrow. Everything from getting out of bed, going to the bathroom, doing a pee, washing your hands, brushing your teeth etc. On your list, progress through your day, writing as many things that you are likely to do the next day as you can think of.

5. Check Point
Refer to your list throughout the day, and put a tick by every thing that you said you would do and that you have done. Feel a sense of satisfaction. Look at all those occasions where YOU DID IT! You succeeded. These are all wins!

This little technique is a great way to re-evaluate your self-image and start seeing yourself as a winner, as someone who achieves what he or she sets out to do. The plain fact is that you DO achieve 99.9% of the things you set out to do on the average day. You just never congratulated yourself for it. You never even acknowledged that.

Let's change that fact and feel good about YOU. God, you are so brilliant I could eat you up! *Yum!*

Reference:

This technique came from Chapter 1 'Winning' from the Life Transformation System by Jorj Elprehzleinn.

This manual floats around in the New Agey end of the pond but has some very unique insights and ideas nonetheless.

If you want to check it out, see:

http://www.wilywalnut.com/Life-Transformation-System.html

Brain Squeezer 040: Mini-Days

Time to read: However long it takes it pay multiple dividends in saved time and greater achievement.

Purpose: Become more efficient and achieve more.

Instructions:

1. For 3 days, make note of everything you do at work.

2. When you have 3 days worth of tasks listed, evaluate the list. Categorize your tasks into the main physical movements.

Here's an example from a publishing executive:

1) phone calls,
2) letter writing,
3) copy writing,
4) accounting,
5) meetings,
6) operations.

All his tasks could be categorized into these main physical movements.

3. Figure out the approximate percentage of your day that you spend doing each of those main physical movements.

If you work an 10 hour day, how much of that day do you need to devote to phone calls, for example?

You should end up with a list something like this:

1) phone calls	20%	or	2 hours
2) letter writing	10%	or	1 hour
3) copy writing	20%	or	2 hours
4) accounting	15%	or	1.5 hours
5) meetings	15%	or	1.5 hours
6) operations	20%	or	2 hours

4. Create a daily schedule, in which you block out those periods of time in which you will devote yourself entirely to just one main physical action, like phone calls.

For example:

8-10 AM:	phone calls (2 hours)
10-11 AM:	letter writing (1 hour)
11-1 PM:	operations (2 hours)
1-3 PM:	copywriting (2 hours)
3-4.30 PM:	meetings (1.5 hours)
4.30-6 PM:	accounting (1.5 hours)

5. Each period of time that you block out to devote to one main physical action, such as making phone calls, is called a 'mini-day'.

You work from your to-do-list. If you have a list of phone calls to make, you sit down at your designated start time, and start calling.

You keep going making call after call until your time is up. If you still have calls to make on your list, they get carried over to the next day...
or you re-evaluate later whether you need to adjust your mini-day schedule.

6. By creating and working this system, and letting your work colleagues know that you are working to this system, you minimize distractions and disruptions.

You become highly focused and can get much more done. This is your personal production line method, where you become highly focused at doing one physical movement over and over rather than jumping from one task to another in a distracted manner.

Try it.

Reference:

Chapter 5, *'Neo-Tech Cosmic Business Control'* by Mark Hamilton

Resource:

Out Of Every Thousand People...
The most organized person will achieve the most, do it faster with the least amount of effort AND have the most free time... Learn NOW how simple & easy it is to be that one in a thousand.
==> http://www.wilywalnut.com/I-am-organized-now.html

Brain Squeezer 041: Mirror Mirror

Time to read: 58 seconds

Purpose: To concentrate your power

Instructions:

1. Stand in front of a large mirror at a time when you will not be disturbed by anyone else.

2. Breathe and relax as you begin to stare at yourself in the mirror.

3. Gaze into your eyes and allow your mind to become quieter. Let all judgements about yourself fall away.

4. Just concentrate on your eyes.

5. Don't freak out if the face you are looking at starts to change and morph into other faces. Some people say this is you seeing your face from other lifetimes. Some think that you could be getting psychic impressions. Others just think it's just something that the mind does rather like seeing patterns or faces in clouds. Be curious and just observe.

6. Watch the movements of your thoughts and compare with the stillness of that YOU in the mirror. If you like, you can repeat an affirmation like, "I am powerful" or "Peace, be still, and know that I am God."

7. Notice how powerful you would be if you could just BE, like that mirror self, so silent, present and still.

8. Allow that sense of power and stillness to resonate deep within you. That mirror self is YOU, the real you, not the distorted self-image created by your thinking.

Reflections:

You are powerful beyond measure. Your consciousness is vast. You have the slimmest idea of how huge your potential is.

It is much, much bigger than you have even dreamed.... But you don't live like that. Instead, you live shackled in some bonsai'd, distorted self-image.

Use this exercise to feel your true power. Sense the power of your mind, of your awareness and presence. Look in the mirror and observe your power.

Look in the mirror and accept yourself fully and completely.

Resources:

Louise Hay offers advice on using mirror work to re-program your mind and exchange limitations for freedom, love, health and prosperity.

Brain Squeezer 042: Power Feel

Time to read: 50 seconds

Purpose: To increase your creative power

Observations: Creativity takes two forms: Receiving and Expressing. To receive you must be empty, to express you must be powerful.

Instructions:

1. Do the mirror mirror work in brain squeezer 041. Or get out at night and stare at the stars. Let their austere stillness and the vastness of space sear into your soul. Or simply bring yourself fully and watchfully into this-moment-NOW! Observe!

2. By being watchful and witnessing everything that is happening in your consciousness right now (that which is going on 'inside' and that which is going on 'outside') you increase your awareness. You become still.

3. When you are still and watchful and listening, you can receive genuine inspiration. Lightning can strike. This is the most powerful aspect of your being. In this supreme presence-fullness, you are perfectly positioned to express from the best of your ability.

Expand your awareness -- and feel the power!

Resources:

Anything by Jiddhu Krishnamurti

'Instant Enlightenment' by David Deida

The Super Mind Evolution System
See: http://www.wilywalnut.com/TSMES2.html

Brain Squeezer 043: Life Teachers

Time to read: 33 seconds

Purpose: Stop fighting against what is - and benefit from it!

Observations: The grass is rarely greener. And so what if it is? Maybe you are supposed to water, fertilize and tend your own grass!

Instructions:

1. Adopt the idea that the people in your life are your teachers.

2. Adopt the idea that the circumstances in your life this moment are perfectly designed modules to teach you what you most need to learn.

3. Adopt the idea that life is conspiring to help you! Imagine that it is 'bending over backwards' to accomodate just what you need in order to learn needed lessons.

Reference:

We Are Here To Learn Lessons and The World Is Our Teacher

"Follow Your Heart" by Andrew Matthews

See: http://www.wilywalnut.com/Andrew-Matthews.html

Brain Squeezer 044: Overrated Thought

Time to read: 58 seconds

Purpose: Learn to act from innate wisdom.

Observation: 90% of your thinking is a complete waste of time. Stop thinking, and get on with DOING!

Instructions:

1. Use any methods you know or that we have discussed to get still. Bring yourself into the focus of your being. Tune your awareness and bring your consciousness up to it's most resonant state of being.

2. You are powerful, wise and creative. That's a fact. You do not have to think about it. Most thinking is from the little distorted self-image self. It's just a delaying tactic.

3. Force yourself up and into your senses. Get moving and get doing. Push thinking out and behind you. Thinking is overrated.

4. Your job is to receive and do. Keep doing and you will receive.

5. Thinking is just interference. Thinking is static on the line. Thinking muddies the water. The real creative generation takes place outside of your conscious mind anyway. The thinking is already

done for you. So be like the birds and the bees and just do what you do.

Creativity is ACTION in the present moment!

Resources:

'Ready, Fire, Aim' by Michael Masterson

Plus, unique and pertinent mind power strategies and techniques revealed in The Super Mind Evolution System:

http://www.wilywalnut.com/TSMES2.html

Brain Squeezer 045: Juxtaposition Joker

Time to read: 44 seconds

Purpose: Expand your creative mind.

Instructions:

1. Play with opposites.

Female/Male.
Light/Dark.
Positive/Negative.
Evil/Good.
Up/Down.
Out/In.
Right/Left.
Love/Fear.
Democrat/Republican? ;-)

2. Try and contain both polarities.

3. Feel the dynamic tension between them.

4. Self-evolve beyond polarised positions. You're bigger than that. Entrenched views are for little people. Why not be God-like?

5. Creativity = receive and express, in and out, female and male, negative and positive, yin and yang, dark and light.

6. What's above Heaven? What's below Hell? You are! What contains both? You do!

7. You are the Creator. (Don't sweat it. It's just what you do.) But you are also the Created. You are everything and nothing.

Funny huh?

8. Try and be both at the same time. See if you can contain it all.

Reference:

Your life.

'Instant Enlightenment' by David Deida (a master of the juxtaposition).

Brain Squeezer 046: Psychic Stretch

Time to read: 1 minute and 50 life-changing seconds!

Purpose: Enlarge your self-concept, stretch your mind, enliven your energy.

Instructions:

1. Lie down on your bed. Close your eyes, get comfortable, and relax deeply.

2. Feel your body from the inside. That's called aperception.

3. Feel your feet, your legs, your hips, butt, groin, your stomach and lower back, your chest and upper back, your hand and arms, your neck, face and scalp. Just feel the sensation in your body.

4. Put your attention at the top of your head and mentally outline your body, like you are drawing a chalk line around it, about an inch (2.5 cm) from your skin.

5. Feel the energy contained within that outline.

6. Now imagine that your legs are growing longer, and your torso is growing longer, so that your 'energy feet' are about a 3ft (1 metre) below where your physical feet, and your 'energy head' is about 3ft above where your physical head is (even if that means you've gone through the headboard and the wall!)

7. Return to normal size. Then try shrinking your energy self until you are half your normal size. Then return to normal size. Keep expanding and contracting your energy body to different sizes. Use your imagination. Become as big as a house, then as small as a mouse and so on.

8. Feel your energy body. Then perform these imagination exercises trying to actually feel what you are imagining:

- Float up above your physical body.
- Sink below your physical body. Yes, right down through the bed!
- Imagine your head and body floats up until you are in an upright standing position.
- Imagine your feet and body floats up until you are upside down in a headstand position.

Return to normal position between each exercise.

- Imagine rolling to the right and then to the left.
- Imagine standing on the other side of the room looking back at your self.

9. Play with these exercises and when you are finished, relax back into your physical body position.

10. Put your attention at the top of your head and mentally outline your body, in the opposite direction this time, like you are drawing a chalk line around it. What you are really doing is containing your energy and focusing it.

11. Count to 10 and open your eyes feeling refreshed and energized.

Reference:

'The Quickening' by Stuart Wilde

Resources:

The Be Psychic Course - unleash your hidden psychic talents!
See: http://www.wilywalnut.com/Be-Psychic.html

Brain Squeezer 047: Spotlight Joy

Time to read: 60 seconds

Purpose: Become energized, enthused and joyful.

Instructions:

1. Visualize yourself looking the best you've ever looked. Imagine that there is a great radiance around you, as though you are imbued with golden light and Grace. Feel wonderful as though all of God's Love is shining in and through you.

2. Imagine a big stage within a huge auditorium with thousands of people in the audience who have come to see and support you. See it in as much detail as possible.

3. You are a singer. See yourself dressed beautifully in blue (gowns for ladies, suits for men).

4. See a piano in the centre of the stage. The curtains slowly open to thunderous applause, and you walk forward to the spotlight at the front of the stage.

5. The applause continues. See yourself turn and nod to the pianist. The audience becomes quiet as the pianist begins to play and you begin to sing.

6. See yourself singing the most beautiful song, the one you love most. See yourself singing with courage and enthusiasm. You feel no fear, you feel

completely at home on the stage. You are so happy to be here singing with all your heart.

7. When you finish your song, see the crowd applauding for a long time. Walk off stage and then come back again as they continue to clap and cheer you.

8. See yourself singing another song. This song is even more beautiful and joyful than the first.

9. When you finish, imagine the audience leaping to their feet to applaud you, they are screaming and calling your name! Some young people clamber onto the stage with flowers for you and tears of happiness in their eyes.

10. Express your love and gratitude to all the people in the audience.

Now, what do you need to do in your life to start getting that sort of response from YOUR audience, in whatever you do?

Brain Squeezer 048: Director's Cut

Time to read: 60 seconds

Purpose: Transform your negative imagination into a positive one.

Background: At the end of each day's filming, movie directors take time to review the footage (or 'rushes') they have shot. This gives them a chance to see how they movie is progressing and choose the best scenes for inclusion in the final film. It also enables them to spot anything that might need to be re-shot.

Instructions:

1. At night, lie down in bed, and review the 'rushes' of your day. Your life is the movie starring YOU!

2. Go into the theatre of your mind and replay the story of your day's activities upon the screen of life.

3. Notice whether you come across as the dynamic, creative, powerful person you wish to be. Or do you seem drab, dull, and dim-witted?

4. Select from the day's activities several of the most telling scenes.

5. Now, replay them, but this time see the scene unfolding exactly how you would have liked it to be played and acted out.

6. Replace weakness and indecision with strength of purpose, decisiveness and a go-getter attitude. Re-shoot those scenes where you were negative, over-cautious or timid. Say, *'once more with feeling'* to YOU the actor and see the scene played out with dynamism, positivity and a lust for life!

7. Do this regularly. Every night. Replace the negative scenes with the positive scenes that you want. These improved scenes start out being projected on your mind's eye but will eventually be projected into your LIFE!

Be the director of your life!

"And... ACTION!"

Reference:

'Act Your Way To Successful Living' by Neil and Margaret Rau

Brain Squeezer 049: Creative Metaphoughts

Time to read: 83 wonderful seconds

Purpose: Boost your creativity; forge new neural networks!

Quote: *"The greatest thing, by far, is to be a master of the metaphor."* ~ Aristotle

Background: Metaphorical thinking involves the creative ability to recognize ways in which two different things share similar traits or embody a common principle.

You can 'force' these connections using the creative tools of simile and metaphor.

A simile is evoked when you describe how two things are connected by using the words 'like' or 'as'.

> **eg.** *"Love is like a butterfly ,*
> *As soft and gentle as a sigh,*
> *The multicolored moods of love*
> *are like its satin wings."*

(*ahem*... thanks Dolly P!)

A metaphor is created when you ascribe the attributes of one thing to another.

> eg. *"All the world's a stage,*
> *And all the men and women merely players;*
> *They have their exits and their entrances;"*

Here William Shakespeare is connecting world and stage. He is saying life is like theatre. He then elaborates on that and says that all the people are like actors in the play of life.

Metaphors are great ways of reframing the way you look at something. If you adopt the metaphor that *'Life is my playground'* you will have a completely different attitude than someone who lives by the metaphor that *'Life is war'* or *'It's a jungle out there!'*

Instructions:

1. Create some similes and metaphors around any of the following words;

- Money
- Love
- Genius
- Creativity
- Music

2. What things are metaphorically like the above words (think of animals, plants, colors, shapes, minerals, etc)?

Examples:

- MONEY is like a lion that can hunt down what you want.
- LOVE is the sunlight that shines from your heart.

- A sip of GENIUS makes you drunker than a bottle of champagne.
- CREATIVITY is a flower that blooms when cultivated.
- MUSIC is as sweet to the ear as honey is melodious to the tongue.

Reference:

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Simile

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Metaphor

Brain Squeezer 050: Inspiration Maker

Time to read: Not long! Just 64 life changing seconds!

Purpose: Daily motivation to get creative!

Observation: You can't wait for inspiration. You'll waste too much time. Let inspiration know you are ready by getting down to your work every day. Just start. Inspiration comes when you are underway.

Quote:

> *"The worst is that the very hardest thinking will not bring thoughts. They must come like good children of God and cry 'Here we are'. But neither do they come unsought. You expend effort and energy thinking hard. Then, after you have given up, they come sauntering in with their hands in their pockets. If the effort had not been made to open the door, however, who knows if they would have come?"*
>
> ~ Goethe

Practice:

1. Eliminate procrastination whenever it arises. Just cut off it's head straight away by leaping into action. Don't concern yourself with getting it right, but as success coach Mike Litman says, just get it going.

2. The discipline of creativity is sticking to a work schedule. Creativity is not all fun and games. Mostly it's about pushing and stretching and creating dynamic tensions which find unexpected release into new insights.

Quote 2:

> *"Thou, O God, dost sell us all good things at the price of labour."*
>
> ~ Leonardo da Vinci

Reference:

'The Art of Creative Thinking' by John Adair

Tagline at http://www.mikelitman.com/blog/

My wife has a coffee mug which on one side says, 'JESUS IS COMING' and on the other it says, 'LOOK BUSY!'

If you want INSPIRATION to come, you had better look busy too!

Wily's Housekeeping

This is the end of Volume 1 of Brain Squeezers. Thank you for being on the Brain Squeezers list. I hope these ideas have helped to trigger your creativity and have been of value to you. I have endeavoured to keep them as succinct and practical as I can, and apologise if I have waivered from that line!

A Favour

May I ask for your help?

1. If you have enjoyed being on the Brain Squeezers list, or reading the articles on my site, please write and let me know at: wily@wilywalnut.com
2. Can I have a testimonial?
3. Will you add my articles or newsletter sign up page to your social bookmarks?
4. Do you have any questions you would like to ask me, or topics you would like to see written about? Please let me know what your particular interests are.
5. Want to just say HI? I'd love to hear from YOU!

Thank you for giving me the opportunity to share some thoughts, ideas and strategies with you.

Wishing you the best of the best,
Wily

Email: wily@wilywalnut.com